

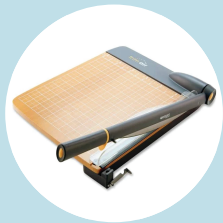
# Working Safely With Sharp Blades Or Edges In The Office



Utility Knives



X-Acto Knives



Paper Cutters



Tape Dispensers



Scissors

## WEAR:

- Safety glasses (CSA or ANSI-certified) to protect your eyes in case the blade breaks.
- Cut or puncture-resistant gloves (e.g., box cutter gloves) to prevent injury (e.g., from utility knife, sharp wires).

## INSPECT:

- The tool for defects before and after use. Take defective tools out of service.
- The blade to ensure it is sharp and properly positioned in the handle. Follow manufacturer's instructions for changing blades.

## WHEN USING TOOL:

- Use tools only as intended and follow any manufacturer instructions.
- Choose tools that have safety handles. Hold tool by the handle and with your dominant hand.
- Do not apply excessive pressure on the blade or rush during cutting.
- Retract/close blades fully and place guard back in place after use.
- Rest material to be cut on a stable surface. Use a cutting board and/or slip-resistant matting to prevent sliding. Ensure material is properly secured before cutting.
- Cut away from your body. Keep extremities and body out of cutting path. Work in a well-lit space.
- For any replacement parts (e.g., blades), ensure they are sealed in a hard container or original packaging. Dispose of dull or broken blades in a puncture-resistant container.
- Consider tools with a self-retracting mechanism, shielded blade, or rounded tip blade to reduce the risk of injury.
- Do not pass or throw a tool to someone else. Carry tool with pointed end facing down. Place tool on counter and allow other person to pick it up.
- Store tools properly. Avoiding leaving out on tables or workspaces after use.

